

**Your community.
Your foundation.**



2024 Community Fund Granting

As a Community Fundholder, your contributions allow us to address the dynamic needs of our community through this permanent fund. Your trust is priceless and essential to our endeavors. Without your support, none of this would be achievable. We extend our heartfelt gratitude for your generosity. Thank you!

Community Vitality Grants

London Public Library Transitional Case Workers Program

London Public Library | \$280,000 over 3 years

The London Public Library has partnered with the *Canadian Mental Health Association Thames Valley Addiction and Mental Health Services* (CMHA-TVAMHS) to provide the Transitional Case Workers Program at the Central Library. It offers free walk-in support and referrals for mental health, addiction, food security, housing and other challenges people are facing who may otherwise not visit a CMHA-TVAMHS site. The Case Worker assists with mitigating and de-escalating potentially volatile situations to maintain a welcoming and comforting environment for all patrons.

MAGICAL (Multicultural Accessible Gatherings Improving 2SLGBTQIA+ Community Affirmation in London)

Regional HIV/AIDS Connection | \$67,000 over 1 year

Regional HIV/AIDS Connection will collaborate with grassroots groups and community leaders to support the well-being of London's 2SLGBTQIA+ community members, especially people disproportionately impacted by systemic oppression. The MAGICAL Project will create new joy-centred spaces, opportunities, and resources that provide connection, affirmation, and visibility. These robust community development efforts will focus on offering vibrant and diverse social gatherings, investing in local 2SLGBTQIA+ talent, and fostering future sustainability through volunteer engagement, project impact evaluation, and mentorship opportunities.

Francophone Ethnocultural Friendship Bench

Canadian Mental Health Association Thames Valley Addiction and Mental Health Services (CMHA TVAMHS) | \$140,181 over 3 years

CMHA-TVAMHS is introducing an innovative approach to mental health support influenced by a model created in Zimbabwe, known as the *Friendship Bench* to support diverse French-speaking people, many of whom are newcomers to Canada from countries in Africa. Trusted community

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members are trained to connect with people informally in a safe and comfortable space to discuss and problem-solve challenges and assist with referrals to appropriate services. The project involves several partners who have existing services and connections within Francophone ethnocultural communities, including, *Family Service Thames Valley*, *L'Entite 1*, *Acces-Franco-Sante London*, *Carrefour Francophone de London*, *Reseau en Immigration Francophone Centre Sud-Ouest*, and *MINDS of London-Middlesex*.

Food Foundations for Self-Reliance

LIFE*SPIN (Low-Income Family Empowerment Sole-Support Parents Information Network) | \$350,000 over 3 years

LIFE*SPIN, in partnership with *On The Move Organics*, aims to increase food security among families with low-incomes by expanding its successful food-focused programs to five new communities and growing its family partnerships to 100. Its Community Food Box program provides families with free food boxes of fruits and vegetables and its Pocket-Sized Farm program equips families with the skills and resources needed to grow food in their backyards and neighbourhoods. Leveraging partnerships and resources, LIFE*SPIN aims for a lasting impact in feeding families, nourishing hope, and fostering change.

Collaborating for a Safer London

Changing Ways | \$150,000 over 2 years

Changing Ways will increase its preventative efforts to address the roots of gender-based violence by sustaining the Community Engagement and Research Coordinator, a position initially established as a pilot project funded by the Government of Canada's *Community Services Recovery Fund*. The Coordinator will grow awareness of Changing Ways services to potential clients at all stages of change to get people the support they might need as quickly as possible. The Coordinator is key to establishing new partnerships and supporting existing ones through advocacy, public education, and research and development of new initiatives.

Women of the World Childcare Provision

London InterCommunity Health Centre | \$63,000 over 3 years

The London InterCommunity Health Centre (LIHC) will expand its successful peer-led program for newcomer women, Women of the World, by hiring, training, and supporting newcomer women to provide childcare at program gatherings. LIHC will aim to hire those who have work experience in the child education sector in their countries of origin to address barriers to employment, such as 'Canadian experience,' which is often a tacit requirement for securing a job. The type of childcare



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offered will be more robust, structured, and include culturally aware activities with a focus on health and well-being. The integration of childcare within the program will make it possible for more women to participate.

Cultivating Food Security Through Urban Agriculture

Urban Roots London in partnership with Siloam United Church | \$282,354 over 3 years

Urban Roots London will expand its partnership with *Siloam United Church* to grow food in the urban garden on the church's land. Since 2021, the partnership has produced over 5,000 pounds of food for families facing food insecurity. Urban Roots will also enhance its growing infrastructure, facilitating increased food production from May to October and year-round to help provide access to fresh vegetables even in the fall and winter months. They anticipate boosting food production by approximately 8,000 pounds to offer more affordable fresh produce to the community.

Collaboratory Community Outreach Program

Forest City Gallery | \$120,775 over 3 years

Forest City Gallery will expand its Collaboratory which is a comprehensive and holistic program of resources, mentorship, training, and information sharing. Through the addition of digital tools and new audio equipment as well as the expansion of the Gallery's workshop, training, and mentorship offerings, artists gain access to a supportive ecosystem to realize their full potential. Seasonal Art Bus Tours will also be facilitated, weaving through local and regional cultural hotspots, to showcase the rich tapestry of artistic talent and foster stronger community ties and accessibility to the arts.

Additional 2024 Community Fund Grant Recipients

Across Languages Translation and Interpretation
Alzheimer Society Southwest Partners
Anova: A Future Without Violence
Can-Voice Consumer/Survivor Community Support Services
Central Ontario Developmental Riding Program
Childreach Centre
Community Foundations of Canada
Congregation of the Sisters of St. Joseph in Canada
Fairy Godparents London
Family Services Thames Valley
Fanshawe Pioneer Village
Glen Cairn Community Resource Centre

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Heart-Links Lazos de Corazon
Hockey Helps the Homeless
Huron Hospice
Hyatt Mosque
Indwell Community Homes
Internet Sense First
Junior Achievement Southwestern Ontario
John Howard Society of London and District
Karen's Place
Korean Society of London
L'Arche London
London & Area Food Bank
London Cares Homeless Response Services
London Children's Museum
London Cross Cultural Learner Centre
London Cycle Link
London Environmental Network
London Humane Society
London Muslim Mosque
London Symphonia
Make-A-Wish Foundation
Muslim Wellness Network
Niagara Community Foundation
Nimkee Nupigawagan Healing Centre
Oneida Nation of the Thames
Oxford Community Foundation
Pathways Employment Help Centre
Pillar Nonprofit Network
The Quest Centre in partnership with Quad County Support Services
ReForest London
Rights and Responsibilities Awareness Initiative
Sakeenah Canada
SARI Therapeutic Riding
Sarnia Humane Society
Shad Canada
Start2Finish Canada
Teen Challenge Canada
Thames Talbot Land Trust



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Thames Valley District School Board
Thames Valley Education Foundation
The London Singers
Unity Project
W.E.A.N. Community Centre
Wesley-Knox United Church
Women's Rural Resource Centre
Western University
Youth Centre for Change

For the full listing of all London Community Foundation grant recipients, see the Foundation's 2024 Impact Report.